

4 Month Sleep Regression Guide — Action Checklist

PRINT THIS PAGE AND KEEP IT SOMEWHERE VISIBLE

UNDERSTAND THE SCIENCE

- ☐ **Recognize that this is a permanent neurological milestone, not a regression — your baby's brain is developing on schedule and this is a positive sign of healthy development that you did not cause.:** Recognize that this is a permanent neurological milestone, not a regression — your baby's brain is developing on schedule and this is a positive sign of healthy development that you did not cause.
- ☐ **Learn that your baby now sleeps with adult-like architecture cycling through four distinct stages, which means partial wakings at transition points now trigger more complete awakenings than before.:** Learn that your baby now sleeps with adult-like architecture cycling through four distinct stages, which means partial wakings at transition points now trigger more complete awakenings than before.
- ☐ **Accept that frequent night wakings are not caused by your parenting choices, and stop blaming yourself for something that is a normal part of brain development at this age.:** Accept that frequent night wakings are not caused by your parenting choices, and stop blaming yourself for something that is a normal part of brain development at this age.
- ☐ **Prepare mentally for a 2 to 6 week timeline before expecting improvement, and avoid making major sleep changes during this developmental window when your baby's brain is still reorganizing.:** Prepare mentally for a 2 to 6 week timeline before expecting improvement, and avoid making major sleep changes during this developmental window when your baby's brain is still reorganizing.

SUPPORT SLEEP NAVIGATION

- ☐ **Create consistent and calming sleep conditions by minimizing sensory disruptions like temperature changes, sounds, and light since four-month-olds are now alert enough to notice these differences.:** Create consistent and calming sleep conditions by minimizing sensory disruptions like temperature changes, sounds, and light since four-month-olds are now alert enough to notice these differences.
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- ☐ **Help your baby learn to connect sleep cycles by offering gentle support at wakings without fully stimulating them, allowing practice with transition periods between cycles.:** Help your baby learn to connect sleep cycles by offering gentle support at wakings without fully stimulating them, allowing practice with transition periods between cycles.

- ☐ **Avoid sleep training methods that involve leaving your baby to cry alone during this specific developmental window, as these approaches can create unnecessary distress.:** Avoid sleep training methods that involve leaving your baby to cry alone during this specific developmental window, as these approaches can create unnecessary distress.

- ☐ **Understand that self-soothing is a skill that emerges based on neurological readiness, and you cannot rush or force a baby to develop it before their brain is capable.:** Understand that self-soothing is a skill that emerges based on neurological readiness, and you cannot rush or force a baby to develop it before their brain is capable.

PROTECT YOUR ENERGY

- ☐ **Lower your expectations of yourself for the next several weeks and focus only on basic survival rather than trying to optimize or fix the situation right now.:** Lower your expectations of yourself for the next several weeks and focus only on basic survival rather than trying to optimize or fix the situation right now.

- ☐ **Remind yourself daily that this is a temporary season and not your permanent reality, even when exhaustion makes it feel like it will never end.:** Remind yourself daily that this is a temporary season and not your permanent reality, even when exhaustion makes it feel like it will never end.

- ☐ **Recognize that your frustration is coming from sleep deprivation and not your baby's behavior, and separate your emotional response from your baby's actual needs.:** Recognize that your frustration is coming from sleep deprivation and not your baby's behavior, and separate your emotional response from your baby's actual needs.

- ☐ **Focus on simply getting through each day rather than trying to solve the sleep regression, understanding that time and brain maturation will resolve much of this naturally.:** Focus on simply getting through each day rather than trying to solve the sleep regression, understanding that time and brain maturation will resolve much of this naturally.